PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #79 · SUBSTANCE ABUSE

“I’ve already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now.”

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Where it often comes from

“I’ve already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now” is hopelessness wearing the clothes of realism. The past may be genuinely damaged: trust, health, money, time, relationships. None of that is brushed aside here. The lie is the conclusion that more harm is the logical next step, and that mercy is no longer on offer. Stopping still matters on the worst day. It matters because you are still alive, and because God’s mercies are new in the morning, not only in the years before things went wrong. If this belief includes wanting to die, please reach for help now. You do not have to decide the rest of your life today. If you want help, call the SAMHSA National Helpline at 1-800-662-4357. Do not try to stop or withdraw on your own if that could make you sick. A doctor can help you do it safely, and a counselor can walk with you. Needing that help is not a failure. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 in the United States, or tell someone near you right away.

What Scripture teaches

Because of the Lord’s loving devotion we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning. There is no condemnation in Christ Jesus. God says not to be locked on the former things, because He is doing something new, a way in the wilderness. Put your hope in God. Approach the throne of grace for mercy and help. These verses were written for people with real wreckage behind them. They do not say the past was small. They say it is not a reason to keep going down.

> *“Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!”* (Lamentations 3:22–23).

Also see

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” (Romans 8:1).

> “‘Do not call to mind the former things; pay no attention to the things of old. Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert.’” (Isaiah 43:18–19).

> “Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him, my Savior and my God” (Psalm 42:11).

> “Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need” (Hebrews 4:16).

Common self-statements

- It is too late.
- I have already ruined it, so more does not matter.
- Mercy is for people who stopped sooner.
- God is done with me.
- There is no point in a doctor now.
- I might as well disappear.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Deciding the rest of your life is already ruined.

- All-or-nothing thinking: If you cannot undo the past, the future is pointless.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling finished and calling that God's verdict.
- Discounting the positive: Refusing any help because it cannot rewrite every consequence.

Challenging questions

- What is actually lost, and what am I adding by saying nothing left matters?
- Would I tell a friend it was pointless for them to stop today?
- What is one thing stopping would still protect?
- Where do I see "new every morning" arguing with "no point"?
- Who can help me with the next day, not the whole repair?
- If I am thinking about dying, who will I contact before today ends?

Truth summary

> What I have done is not the end of the story. God's mercy is new today, and stopping still matters.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

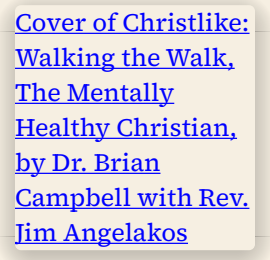
- Hopeless
- Forgiveness
- Guilt/Shame
- Faith
- Help

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Depression
- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Prayer

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



Cover of Christlike: Walking the Walk, The Mentally Healthy Christian, by Dr. Brian Campbell with Rev. Jim Angelakos

From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from "The Mentally Healthy Christian" (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God makes things new. A damaged chapter is not the end of the story.

Broken Things — Matthew West
God works with broken things. You do not have to be undamaged before you stop.

Grace Wins — Matthew West
Grace wins over the sentence that it is too late.

To God Be the Glory — Reawaken Hymns
To God be the glory for mercy, including mercy that starts today.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I've already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I've already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What is actually lost, and what am I adding by saying nothing left matters?
- ☐ Would I tell a friend it was pointless for them to stop today?
- ☐ What is one thing stopping would still protect?
- ☐ Where do I see "new every morning" arguing with "no point"?
- ☐ Who can help me with the next day, not the whole repair?
- ☐ If I am thinking about dying, who will I contact before today ends?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ What I have done is not the end of the story. God's mercy is new today, and stopping still matters.
- ☐ The past can be really damaged and still not be the last word.
- ☐ There is a point in stopping today.
- ☐ I am not condemned and finished.
- ☐ God's mercy is new this morning.
- ☐ I can ask for help without first repairing everything.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Lamentations 3:22–23
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"
- ☐ Romans 8:1
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Isaiah 43:18–19
  "'Do not call to mind the former things; pay no attention to the things of old. Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you decided it was too late: Each day, write down one moment when you felt there was no point in stopping. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Lamentations 3:22–23 becomes: "James can write: "His mercies are new this morning. There is still a point in stopping.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. For help with substance use, call 1-800-662-4357, and talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick.

- [ ] If you want to die, call or text 988 or tell someone near you today.
- [ ] Make one appointment or one call to 1-800-662-4357. The point of the call is today, not a repaired past.
- [ ] Ask a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick. A safe plan is still worth making.
- [ ] Read Lamentations 3:22–23 in the morning before you review everything you have ruined.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I've already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now.": _____ %

My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A reason today still mattered
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I've already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have decided it is too late and there is no point. Your mercies are new this morning. There is no condemnation in Christ. Help me stop, and help me stay alive. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.